Isaac **Brito-Morales, Ph.D.**

Senior Associate Scientist · Research Associate

Conservation International, Arlington, United States

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Work and Research

Senior Associate Scientist — *Arlington, United States*
Conservation International, Moore Center for Science — *Jul 2024 – Present*

Associate Research Scientist — *Arlington, United States*
Conservation International, Moore Center for Science — *2021 – Jun 2024*

Research Associate — *Santa Barbara, United States*
University of California, Santa Barbara, Marine Science Institute — *Nov 2024 – Present*

Affiliated Researcher — *Santa Barbara, United States*
University of California, Santa Barbara, Marine Science Institute — *2022 – Oct 2024*

Postdoctoral Research Fellow — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, School of Mathematics and Physics — *Feb 2021 – Sep 2021*

Project Manager — *Chile*
Centro de Ecologia Aplicada — *2010 – 2016*

Lecturer in Experimental Design — *Concepción, Chile*
Universidad Católica de la Santísima Concepción — *2008 – 2009*

Education

Ph.D. Biological Sciences — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland — *2016 – 2021*

B.Sc. 1st Class Hons, Marine Biology — *Concepción, Chile*
Universidad Católica de la Santísima Concepción — *2003 – 2008*

Awards and Honors

Academic Excellence — *Concepción, Chile*
Science Faculty, Universidad Católica de la Santísima Concepción — *2008*

Grants and Fellowships

Save the Blue Five – IKI Project — *International*
International Climate Initiative, BMUV/Germany; co-lead on climate change vulnerability and conservation planning for highly migratory megafauna — *2023 – Present*

Belmont Forum / Ocean Front Change Project — *International*
Contributor to international project on climate and dynamic ocean features — *2021 – 2024*

Peer-Reviewed Publications

In Press and Published

Sanz-Martín M, Olguin-Jacobson C, Bolin JA, Quiles-Pons C, **Brito-Morales I**, García Molinos J, Hidalgo M, Alabia ID, Gissi E, Provost MM, Micheli F, Arafeh-Dalmau N. 2026. Identifying marine climate refugia to advance climate-smart conservation. *Trends in Ecology & Evolution*. In press. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tree.2026.04.007.

Buenafe KCV, Dunn DC, Metaxas A, Schoeman DS, Everett JD, Pidd A, Hanson JO, Bentley LK, Kim SW, Neubert S, Scales KL, Dabalà A, **Brito-Morales I**, Richardson AJ. 2025. Current approaches and future opportunities for climate-smart protected areas. *Nature Reviews Biodiversity*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s44358-025-00041-0.

Hannah L, Irvine A, **Brito-Morales I**, Fuller S, Davies T, Tittensor D, Reville G, Shackell N, Hennicke J, Stanley R. 2024. To save the high seas, plan for climate change. *Nature*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/d41586-024-01720-2.

Sanz-Martín M, Hidalgo M, Puerta P, García Molinos J, Zamanillo M, **Brito-Morales I**, González-Irusta JM, Esteban A, Punzón A, García-Rodríguez E, Vivas M, López-López L. 2024. Climate velocity drives unexpected southward patterns of species shifts in the Western Mediterranean Sea. *Ecological Indicators*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.ecolind.2024.111741.

Schoeman DS, Sen Gupta A, Harrison CS, Everett J, **Brito-Morales I**, Hannah L, Bopp L, Roehrdanz P, Richardson AJ. 2023. Demystifying global climate models for use in the life sciences. *Trends in Ecology & Evolution*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tree.2023.04.005.

Buenafe KCV, Dunn D, Everett J, **Brito-Morales I**, Schoeman DS, Hanson JO, Dabalà A, Neubert S, Cannicci S, Kaschner K, Richardson AJ. 2023. A metric-based framework for climate-smart conservation planning. *Ecological Applications*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1002/eap.2852.

Brito-Morales I, Schoeman DS, Everett J, Klein CJ, Dunn D, García Molinos J, Burrows MT, Buenafe KCV, Dominguez RM, Possingham HP, Richardson AJ. 2022. Towards climate-smart, three-dimensional protected areas for biodiversity conservation in the high seas. *Nature Climate Change* 12, 402–407. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41558-022-01323-7.

Arafeh-Dalmau N, **Brito-Morales I**, Schoeman DS, Possingham HP, Klein CJ, Richardson AJ. 2021. Incorporating climate velocity into the design of climate-smart networks of marine protected areas. *Methods in Ecology and Evolution*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1111/2041-210X.13675.

Brito-Morales I, Schoeman DS, García Molinos J, Burrows MT, Klein CJ, Arafeh-Dalmau N, Kaschner K, Garilao C, Kesner-Reyes K, Richardson AJ. 2020. Climate velocity reveals increasing exposure of deep-ocean biodiversity to future warming. *Nature Climate Change* 10, 576–581. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1038/s41558-020-0773-5.

Brito-Morales I, García Molinos J, Schoeman DS, Burrows MT, Poloczanska ES, Brown CJ, Ferrier S, Harwood TD, Klein CJ, McDonald-Madden E, Moore PJ, Pandolfi JM, Watson JEM, Wenger AS, Richardson AJ. 2018. Climate velocity can inform conservation in a warming world. *Trends in Ecology & Evolution* 33, 441–457. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.tree.2018.03.009.

In Preparation, Review or Revision (drafts available upon request)

Isaac Brito-Morales, Yulia Egorova, Lee Hannah, Guillermo Ortuño Crespo, Nur Arafeh-Dalmau. Evolving area-based conservation for a dynamic ocean. *In review*.

Ian Omedes Bassat, Manuel Hidalgo, Carla Quiles-Pons, Jorge García Molinos, **Isaac Brito-Morales**, Nur Arafeh-Dalmau, Javier Soto-Navarro, Marina Sanz-Martín. Multifaceted thermal exposure reveals climate refugia shortfalls in the Mediterranean marine protected areas. *In review*.

Lee Hannah, Sarayu Ramnath, Kylie L. Scales, Vincent Rossi, Ana Sequeira, Tammy E. Davies, Elliott Hazen, Daniel Dunn, Peter I. Miller, Sophie Laran, Valeria Falabella, Lenaya-Aiden Gonzales, **Isaac Brito-Morales**. Ocean fronts concentrate fishing pressure on threatened megafauna. *Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences (PNAS)*. *In review*.

Isaac Brito-Morales, Boris Dewitte, Floriane Sudre, Christoph A. Rohner, Elliott L. Hazen, Kylie L. Scales, Matthieu Le Corre, Audrey Jaeger, Sophie Laran, Olivier Bousquet, Ana M. M. Sequeira, Tammy E. Davies, Daniel C. Dunn, Ronel Nel, Lee Hannah, Vincent Rossi. Megafauna show pervasive yet distinct affinity to ocean fronts: the urgent need for adaptive conservation in a warming world. *Communications Biology*. *In review*. Preprint DOI: https://doi.org/10.1101/2025.06.17.660201

Teaching

Instruction

Instructor — *Santa Barbara, United States*
UCSB, ESM240 Climate Change Biology (graduate course) — *2023, 2025*

- Designed and delivered graduate-level lectures, developed assignments, supervised projects, and evaluated coursework.

Teaching Assistant — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, Advanced Analysis of Scientific Data — *2019 – 2020*

Teaching Assistant — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, Analysis of Scientific Data — *2019 – 2020*

Teaching Assistant — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, Pharmacy – Data Analysis & Professional Practice — *2019 – 2020*

Teaching Assistant — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, Probability & Statistics in Engineering — *2019*

Teaching Assistant — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, Environmental Data Analysis — *2018*

Teaching Assistant — *Brisbane, Australia*
University of Queensland, Biostatistics & Experimental Design — *2018*

Academic Service & Leadership

Organizer — *Toulouse, France*
CERFACS, Climate and Ocean Modeling Workshop: Applications of Regional Ocean Models for Marine Megafauna Conservation in the Southeast Pacific — *2025*

Organizer — *David, Panama*
Conservation International, Climate Change and Marine Megafauna Workshop — *2025*

Invited Workshop Contributor — *Wolfville, Canada*
Acadia University, Ocean Front, Megafauna and Climate Change — *2024*

Invited Workshop Contributor — *Gqeberha, South Africa*
Nelson Mandela University, Ocean Front and Climate Change — *2023*

Conference Presentations

Invited

Cambio climático en el océano: la dimensión ignorada en conservación — *Ciudad de Panamá, Panamá*
Encuentro del Pacífico Sudeste — *2024*

Climate velocity in the ocean and its implications for conservation — *Palma de Mallorca, Spain*
ASLO, S-69: Promoting Resilience Through Climate-Smart Fisheries and Conservation Management — *2023*

Contributed

Ocean Front Change, Belmont Forum Session: Oceans 2018 End-term — *Helsinki, Finland*
Sustainability, Research & Innovation Congress — *2024*

Managing dynamic ocean front ecosystems for species on the move — *Bonita Springs, United States*
Species on the Move — *2023*

Climate velocity in the ocean and its implications for conservation — *Vancouver, Canada*
IMPAC5 — *2023*

Challenges and opportunities for managing ocean front ecosystems in a warming world — *Online*
Ocean Sciences Meeting — *2022*

Life below the ocean surface increasingly threatened by climate change — *Kruger National Park, South Africa*
Species on the Move — *2019*

[redacted]

Languages Spoken

Fluent Spanish; Fluent English